

Weekly Brief — Edition 002

Window: August 17–23, 2026 · compiled August 22, 2026 · eight parallel research tracks

The lede

At 9:00 p.m. Eastern on Friday, August 21, the Postal Service filed a final rule, *Ballot Mail For Federal Elections*, on public inspection at the Federal Register — FR Doc. 2026-17238, 39 CFR Part 111, “Effective August 21, 2026,” publication set for August 26 — implementing Section 3 of the March 31 mail-ballot executive order, ten days after Judge Indira Talwani preliminarily enjoined that section for the November elections [A](#). The rule carries its own limiting sentence: “Given injunctions currently in place in *State of California v. Trump*, No. 26-cv-11581 (D. Mass. June 25, 2026), and *League of Women Voters of Massachusetts v. Trump*, No. 26-cv-11549 (D. Mass. Aug. 11, 2026), the Postal Service will not take actions to implement the rule specifically for the 2026 election unless and until the government obtains relief from those injunctions.” On Saturday, August 22, the plaintiffs filed an emergency motion to enforce the injunction and for expedited briefing, D. Mass. ECF 189, with a supporting affidavit at ECF 191 [A](#). No court has ruled. The enjoined act is completing the rulemaking; the disclaimed act is implementing its result. Both texts are quoted here, and the edge between them stays where the record leaves it — dotted.

The same week subtracted from this corpus twice, and the subtractions are the second half of the lede. The standing line that zero of ten Trump-orbit entities had answered the senators’ immunity-settlement letters is wrong on the senators’ own release: eleven were written to, six answered by July 29, five did not [A](#). And the standing line that Steve Witkoff’s financial disclosure is “uncertified” needs a smaller word: the agency certifying official signed it on December 12, 2025, 121 days after the filer did; the Office of Government Ethics line in the posted version carries no signature [A](#). Both are logged in the permanent Corrections Log: [C-010](#) and [C-011](#).

Architecture I — The family money

The satellite reports. AI Financial Corporation — the registrant this report keeps distinct as ALT5 Sigma under its April name — filed its second-quarter 10-Q on August 17, five days after the late-filing notice, accession 0001493152-26-038732 [A](#). The filing marks the company’s 7,283,585,650 WLFI tokens at \$421.283 million against a cost basis of \$1,456.717 million, a 71 percent write-down at an implied \$0.058 per token; the unrealized loss on the tokens is \$633.45 million for the half-year, which reconciles to the \$348.3 million carried from the first quarter plus \$285.1 million for the second [A](#). The pledge

under the January loan agreement with World Liberty now stands at 378,310,114 tokens, confirming the standing figure **A**. Two things the filing does not say matter as much as what it does. It contains no going-concern paragraph and no “substantial doubt” language — the phrase is “substantial liquidity concerns,” followed by an assertion of twelve months’ sufficiency “based on the current market value of the Company’s WLFI token holdings,” which is to say, on the asset that lost 71 percent **A**. And it discloses no Nasdaq deficiency notice, and no Item 3.01 8-K has been filed in 2026 **A**. The filing asserts the tokens “became fully transferable on August 12, 2026”; the same filing’s first note conditions release of the 3.75 billion-token tranche on stockholder approval, a charter amendment, and an effective resale registration, and EDGAR shows no such registration since August 2025. Whether the unlock executed on-chain is **ABSENT** — asserted by the company, checked against the filing system, unverified against the chain.

The bank, read closely. The OCC’s Corporate Decision #1385 — the document itself, not the coverage — records that the passivity commitments from StringZ Holdings RSC (DE) LLC, DT Marks SC LLC, and AMGUS, LLC were made “in a letter dated July 13, 2026,” a month before approval; that the bank “will not issue, custody, or deal in WLFI tokens”; that the comments raising the family’s conflicts and WLFI token purchases “are outside the scope of the OCC’s review because neither World Liberty Financial, Inc., nor” the foreign investors are parties; and that the decision was made “under authority delegated by the Comptroller to career staff” **A**. The conditions are enforceable under 12 U.S.C. 1818: \$20 million in tier 1 capital, half of it in eligible liquid assets, capital raised within twelve months and doors open within eighteen or the approval lapses. The officer roster the OCC did not object to is Zachary Witkoff as organizer, director, and president, Robert Witkoff and Scott Alper as organizer-directors, and a compliance, BSA, security, and technology bench; Steve Witkoff’s name does not appear **A**. On August 15 Senator Warren and nine colleagues announced the Ending Presidential Corruption in Banking Act, which would bar federal banking approvals where a president, vice president, member of Congress, or immediate family holds more than ten percent or control, and would require review of approvals granted after January 20, 2025 **A**. Warren, on the record: “President Trump is now the first President in history to approve, operate, and supervise his own bank.” World Liberty’s David Wachsmann, to Banking Dive: the company is “running towards regulation and continuous oversight, not away from it” — a posture, not a denial of any fact above **B**.

The machine-readable president. Trump Media’s Form 425 of August 10 carries the earnings-call transcript in which interim chief executive Kevin McGurn says the Truth Social API has “signed more than 10 customer agreements to date, primarily high-frequency trading firms, at rates generally in the range of \$60,000-\$100,000 a month,” and that the company is “evaluating opportunities in the prediction market space for data licensing” **A**. The second-quarter 10-Q dates the API’s launch to August 1 and the CRO Strategy termination to August 7 **A**. This week the feed had something to sell: the August 18 post declaring the Strait of Hormuz “open and operating” and the August 20 post announcing “the MOST CRUSHING ECONOMIC OPERATION EVER TAKEN AGAINST ANY COUNTRY,” each followed within hours by a move in Brent. The posts and the settlements are reported in Architecture III as separate dated facts. The company that sells the posts to the traders is the president’s; the record stops there.

The non-answers, recounted. Warren’s July 29 release corrects this corpus: of eleven organizations written to on July 6 about the alleged May 2026 immunity settlement, six — Trump Media, Polymarket, Kalshi, American Bitcoin, Powerus, and Kaz Resources — “responded by suggesting they were not

involved,” and five, “including the Trump Organization, World Liberty Financial, and 1789 Capital,” did not [A](#). The settlement document itself remains unobtained, thirty-four days past the deadline. The Warren–Reed letter on who bought WLFI is 265 days unanswered; a May 14 follow-up to Secretary Bessent and Acting Attorney General Blanche, on a World Liberty partner led by individuals sanctioned in October 2025, cites the department’s “failure to respond to the original inquiry” and is itself 89 days past its deadline [A](#). New to the ledger: an August 12 letter from Warren and Representative Garcia to the president on more than 17,000 stock trades since the inauguration, naming Meta, GEO Group, and CoreCivic, with a response deadline of August 28 [A](#). A new 1789 Capital vehicle, 1789 Capital Dawn LP, filed a Form D on August 17 reporting \$10.15 million sold to six investors; Donald Trump Jr. is not listed among its related persons [A](#).

The envoy’s disclosure, precisely. The posted Form 278e for Steve Witkoff, signed by the filer on August 13, 2025 with a thirty-day extension, bears the agency certifying official’s electronic signature dated December 12, 2025 [A](#). The Office of Government Ethics certification line in that posted version is not signed. The standing description “uncertified” therefore overstated one thing and understated another: the agency certified it, four months late against a sixty-day norm; the second-level certification is what remains absent, 375 days after the filer signed. Correction C-010 in the permanent Corrections Log carries the precise form.

Architecture II — Executive power

The rule and the injunction. The Postal Service’s final rule is the week’s largest structural fact, so its sequence is set down with dates. Judge Talwani’s preliminary injunction of August 11, ECF 183 in *League of Women Voters v. Trump*, is reproduced as the appendix to the Solicitor General’s August 12 supplemental brief at the Supreme Court, in which the government wrote that “it is critical that the Court act promptly on the pending stay. Otherwise, the district court’s erroneous orders will effectively run out the clock” [A](#). The Court has not acted. Applications 26A124 and 26A139 have been pending without any order since July 27 — twenty-seven days at the close of this window — and the five order lists the Court issued between August 12 and August 21 contain no reference to either docket [A](#). The Postal Service filed its rule on the tenth day after the injunction and the ninth after the government told the Court the clock was running out. The rule’s own text disclaims implementation for 2026 “unless and until the government obtains relief”; a rule published with an effective date, a portal, and state participation lists is nonetheless a completed rulemaking, and the injunction’s operative language, as the plaintiffs quote it, barred “initiating or completing rulemaking” under Section 3. Their emergency motion to enforce was docketed August 22 [A](#). What the court does with it is next week’s record; what the agency did is this week’s.

The monitors, counted two ways. The Justice Department’s own release of August 18 says it monitored the Miami-Dade and Laramie County primaries, that “thus far the DOJ has deployed over 75 monitors across five states and over 200 polling locations this primary season,” and that “during the 2022 midterms the DOJ sent monitors to nine states” [A](#). The day before, on Bloomberg, Assistant Attorney General Harmeet Dhillon said the department would deploy “approximately 1,000 election monitors in the November election,” that “two-thirds of the states are refusing to cooperate,” and that “there’ll be

some prosecutions in the pipeline” **B**. No department document states the thousand. The two figures are kept apart because they measure different things — a season’s deployment and a stated intention — and because only one of them is on letterhead. The voter-roll litigation went the other direction: the District of Minnesota dismissed the department’s suit on August 17, and notices of appeal followed in the D.C., Tenth, Ninth, and Eighth Circuits over two days; the running tally is thirty-one suits, twenty-three dismissals, no wins, one settlement **B**.

Missouri, to the Supreme Court. On August 19 — the day after the hearing date this corpus had carried, a one-day drift now corrected — Cole County Circuit Judge Daniel Green held a same-day trial and ruled within hours that the Secretary of State was right to reject the referendum petition on the 2025 congressional map: “The Missouri Constitution does not supply any statement — let alone a clear one — reallocating authority over congressional redistricting away from the General Assembly to a referendum process” **B**. On August 21 the Missouri Supreme Court took the appeal directly, ordered expedited briefing, and set argument for September 2; September 8 is the last day a court can add a question to the November ballot **B**. The Secretary of State’s position, on the record: “The Missouri First Map remains the law of the land.”

The ballroom, stayed. On August 21 the Chief Justice, acting alone, stayed the April 16 preliminary injunction against the East Wing ballroom construction “pending further order of the undersigned or of the Court” — application 26A203, submitted August 13, response August 18, reply August 19 **A**. The D.C. Circuit had affirmed the injunction two to one on August 7, writing that the question was “not a matter for Executive self-help”; its fourteen-day self-stay would have expired at midnight on the day the Chief Justice acted. This is the only Supreme Court order touching the executive branch in the window, and it went the executive’s way. In the District of Maryland, Judge Chuang vacated the decision to move FBI headquarters to the Ronald Reagan Building as a violation of the Administrative Procedure Act; the bureau’s unsigned response — “The court has chosen to impermissibly intervene for political reasons” — is a statement about the court, not about compliance, and no appeal had been noticed by August 19 **B**.

The files, and a sentence that was not correct. In *Phang v. Blanche*, the contempt order this corpus flagged as the week’s potential lead did not issue. What issued instead is narrower and, on the record, sharper. On August 20 the plaintiff filed a notice, ECF 33, attaching a certified excerpt of the August 13 transcript in which Judge Sullivan asked the department’s counsel whether other handwritten notes had been published and counsel answered, “To my knowledge, not with respect to the 302s”; the notice identifies Bates range EFTA00276889–99 as handwritten notes underlying a published 302 and “nearly 100 additional examples” of such notes already produced **A**. The same transcript has counsel stating the withholding rationale in one word: “The answer, Your Honor, is that they are duplicative documents” **A**. A companion filing, ECF 32, proposed an order requiring the four sets of underlying notes by August 25 and a sworn declaration from the Attorney General or a knowledgeable representative by September 3 **A**.

What the judge did. Judge Sullivan did not adopt it. His August 21 minute order set a response from the department by August 27 and a reply by September 3 **A**. The Federal Register, queried directly, contains no document publishing the Section 2(c)(2) redaction log the June order required; the Inspector General’s audit remains open with no report; the department’s disclosure page carries no

dated release after the February 14 letter to Congress A. Every department statement located this week is scoped away from the allegation — a counsel’s knowledge, a document category, a legal impediment, a best-efforts notice — and none says the material is not being withheld ABSENT.

Two readings of one order. Judge Preska’s August 11 opinion in *Giuffre v. Maxwell*, ECF 1367, granted the government’s motion to modify the protective order so that it may produce a tranche of documents obtained from Boies Schiller under a 2019 grand-jury subpoena, “in accordance with the Government’s obligations under the Epstein Files Transparency Act” and “subject to the Government’s withholding and/or redaction obligations under Section 2(c)” A. That is a permission to produce, not a release; the headlines of August 18 and 19 announcing that a judge had ordered Virginia Giuffre’s case files released trace to one Substack post about that order and overstate it. The docket shows no production, and no newly named person qualifies at any tier. The remaining sealed material is not resolved: the parties and the Miami Herald are to propose next steps by August 28 A. Separately, the Office of Legal Counsel’s opinion extending executive privilege to presidential communications with private advisers bears the date August 10, was written for the Counsel to the President, and applies where communications “relate to official presidential decisionmaking” A; the Attorney General’s description of it as “just clarifying” denies novelty and nothing else.

Absent, verified. The Federal Register’s presidential-documents feed for the window returned four documents — two proclamations, an emergency-continuation notice, and the vaccine-recommendations order of August 10 — and nothing invoking the Insurrection Act, federalizing a Guard, or declaring an election emergency ABSENT. No executive order of structural significance was signed August 17–23. The Senate’s last recorded vote remains roll call #231 of August 8; no vote numbered 232 exists A.

Architecture III — The wars and the count

The tally and the turn. Central Command’s own posts carry the blockade’s running count: sixty-four commercial vessels redirected as of August 17, sixty-seven as of August 20, and, as of August 21, “redirected 68 commercial vessels, disabled 3 and boarded 2 to ensure compliance,” with more than twenty warships supporting B. The disabled and boarded figures have not moved since the *Vela Nova* on August 11. No strike on Iranian territory was announced in the window; the last Central Command strike release remains July 29, and a search-engine line claiming overnight strikes on August 18–19 is rejected below for lack of any record ABSENT.

The posture, in words. On August 18 the president posted that “there are no talks or conversations going on, or scheduled, with the Islamic Republic of Iran,” that “the Hormuz Strait is open and operating,” and a map labeling the strait “New US Territory” A. On August 20 he announced “the MOST CRUSHING ECONOMIC OPERATION EVER TAKEN AGAINST ANY COUNTRY,” branded “Economic D-Day,” with oil purchases, cash transfers, swap lines, and ship registries as triggers for “TREMENDOUS Economic Consequences” against any country offering “any type of lifeline” A. The Treasury Secretary, on CNBC the same day: “This is going to be the greatest coordinated economic isolation in the history of the world”; “we are going to collapse this regime”; the United States likely will not restart large-scale combat; details at a press conference Monday, August 24 A. On August 21,

in Myrtle Beach: “I view the Strait of Hormuz as an American territory right now,” and “What the hell do I have to do? Go back, bomb Iran a little bit more” **B**. Tehran’s replies are attached at their scope: the deputy foreign minister called the economic operation a renaming of “the next failure,” and on August 22 the government called the sanctions a declaration of war on all nations **B**.

The market, separately. Brent settled at \$93.78 on August 20, up 2.4 percent and the highest since July 24, and at \$94.39 on August 21 for a second consecutive weekly gain near six percent; the national gasoline average reached \$4.10 **B**. The statements and the settlements are separate dated facts.

The count, and the bill that carries it. The Defense Casualty Analysis System’s displayed wounded rose from 697 on Wednesday, August 19, to 757 on Thursday, a one-day increase of sixty, with killed-in-action unchanged at eighteen; the split is 418 wounded and fourteen killed under Operation Epic Fury and 339 wounded and four killed under “Overseas Operations,” the category created in July for casualties since July 7. The Pentagon “did not immediately respond Friday” **B**. The only official explanation of the July recategorization remains the acting press secretary’s July 26 line that “site anomalies are currently being resolved” — a technical account that does not address the cutoff date **A**. The legislative response this corpus carried as a Rosen bill is a Duckworth bill: S. 5300, the Honoring the Sacrifice of Troops in War Act, introduced August 6 with seventeen Democratic cosponsors including Senator Rosen, referred to Armed Services; it would bar the recategorization of designated contingency operations and restore the Iran-war records since February 28 **B**. Rosen’s August 14 release, on the record, calls the reclassification “disgraceful and beyond the pale” **A**. Correction C-009 retires the single-sponsor premise.

The carrier, the denials, and the newspaper. The USS *George Washington* relieved the *Abraham Lincoln* on August 19, ending a deployment reported at 272 days **B**. The denials on the *Lincoln*’s condition keep their shapes. Central Command, August 13, on the record: reports that seven sailors died in a brawl and of a spike in suicidal ideation “are FALSE” — a denial of two specific claims. Central Command, August 14: “No service members aboard the aircraft carrier have died, and the one Sailor who fell overboard Aug. 3 was quickly and safely recovered” — a denial of deaths that concedes an overboard. The Navy, to CNN and to Task & Purpose: “we have not identified an increase in reported suicidal ideation or suicide attempts aboard the ship” — knowledge-qualified and rate-qualified, denying an increase, not an existence. The commander of Central Command, aboard on August 17: the *Lincoln* “currently has among the lowest number of cases related to mental health” of eleven carriers, and “not everything was perfect” — a comparison, not a denial **A**. On August 21 the Pentagon fired the publisher, the editor-in-chief, and a Middle East reporter of *Stars and Stripes* for insubordination; the editor, Erik Slavin, said he was fired “for stating in a CBS interview that hypothetical censorship of news for service members would constitute a red line,” and that “Stars and Stripes must remain editorially independent, as required by law and by the department’s own policies” **A**. The paper and the fired reporter were among the originators of the *Lincoln* and casualty-count reporting. That adjacency is recorded; no document connects the firing to the reporting, and none is asserted.

Enforcement, at the source. The latest detention dataset on ICE’s own site as of August 22 is the file dated July 20, a snapshot as of July 11: 65,765 held, 58,231 of them ICE-arrested, 26,189 with no criminal conviction or pending charge **A**. The figure this corpus carried as an independent TRAC count is ICE’s own July 11 number, and the “roughly 68,000 in early August” figure has no ICE dataset behind it; both are corrected in C-012 in the permanent Corrections Log. No ICE death notification was posted in the

window; the most recent is Edwin Lopez-Cornejo, pronounced dead August 1 after detention at Delaney Hall **A**. The Mega Hub solicitation moved again: an August 17 amendment set the response deadline at August 27, while the agency's own written answer of August 13 said August 31, and a vendor's question asking which date controls sits on the record with the government's answer field blank **A**. The agency's answers also fix the shape of the thing: one aggregate value of \$10 billion, no more than two sites per contractor, one contractor for all seven Mega Hub locations — Aguadilla, Broadview, Guantánamo Bay, Huntsville, Oakdale, St. Thomas, Honolulu — to be maintained concurrently, award by September 25 **A**. Not in the standing list and now in it: a sole-source award to Eastern Air Express LLC for aircraft operations, \$215.5 million obligated against \$327.9 million with options, one offer received **A**; a \$63 million task order to Koniag Services for a 287(g) "National Coordination Center" whose place of performance now reads Nashville **A**; and the Camp East Montana contract, whose reported extension to September 2027 is not on the award record — the record still ends September 30, 2026 **A**.

Health and succession, sourced only. No physician's memorandum issued in the window; the last is May 29 **ABSENT**. The named White House response to Dr. Jonathan Reiner's August 12 op-ed — "a disgrace to the medical profession" — contains no clinical content and answers none of his seven questions **B**; Reiner, on CNN, August 14: "I haven't made any diagnosis" **B**. The official schedule shows no public events on August 18 **A**. The press secretary's departure at the end of August and the legislative-affairs director's in September are on the record in the president's own posts, with no successor named for either **A**. On 2028 the poles stand where they stood: "I'd love to run, but the law is very strong" on August 11, and an AI-generated image of himself in a "Trump 2028" cap on August 15 **B**.

The node where the architectures touch

The week's clearest three-body intersection runs through one Friday. On August 21 the Chief Justice stayed the ballroom injunction, a win for the executive on a question of who controls the White House grounds **A**. Nine hours later the Postal Service filed a rule implementing an election order that a federal judge had enjoined ten days earlier, while the government's own emergency application on that order sat unanswered at the same Court for a twenty-sixth day **A**. The same day, in the District of Columbia, a judge converted a plaintiff's request for a sworn declaration from the Attorney General about withheld files into ordinary briefing, due August 27 **A**. Three vertices, three records.

DOTTED EDGE · ADJACENCY, NOT CAUSE

The stay **A** · the rule **A** · the briefing order **A**. Nothing in any of the three documents refers to the others. What would make an edge solid: a Supreme Court order on 26A124 that cites the Postal Service's filing; a Postal Service declaration explaining the timing; a department response on August 27 that addresses the withholding rather than the category. None exists. **ABSENT**

What would change the tier

The Central Command tally moves from B to A with the posts' own permalinks, which the agency's blocked site did not yield this week. The Dhillon thousand moves to A the day a department document states it, and to a rejection the day the department is asked and declines. The casualty figures move to A when the Defense Casualty Analysis System renders without a script or the Pentagon answers the question it did not answer Friday. S. 5300's text and cosponsor list move to A on a congress.gov page that stopped returning 403. The Missouri rulings move to A with the Cole County case number and the Supreme Court's scheduling order, both available on Case.net. The ExodusPoint position, carried at A since Brief 001, could not be re-confirmed by full-text search this week and is held at its prior tier pending the filer's own 13F page. And the dotted edge above closes only with a document that names the other vertex.

Rejected below [B], with reasons

A search-engine synthesis claiming United States strikes on Iran overnight August 18–19 is rejected: no Central Command release, no outlet text, and a same-period summary recording two consecutive quiet days [C]. Context, not a claim: the primary record shows blockade enforcement only — the count of redirected vessels rose from 64 to 68 across the window [B] — and the last strike release on the command's page is dated July 29 [A]. The New Republic and four other headlines announcing that a federal judge ordered Virginia Giuffre's case files released are rejected as characterization: one Substack origin, the order itself permits one government production subject to the Act's redaction provisions [C]; context is the opinion, quoted in Architecture II [A]. CNN's August 21 report that the DHS Secretary's "250,000 noncitizens" claim rests on a Nevada list in which 185 of 15,903 names were confirmed by manual review is a single origin read through syndication and is rejected at tier, with the note that it would be the most consequential election-administration finding of the month if a second origin or the Nevada correspondence surfaces [C]; context is the department's own August 18 release, which states seventy-five monitors and no noncitizen figure [A].

Also rejected. A Coinpedia report that Judge Donato denied World Liberty's motion to compel arbitration in Justin Sun's suit is rejected pending the docket; the case exists at 3:26-cv-03360 [C]. The Washington Post's August 6 account of a donor remark about electing the vice president is rejected as anonymous and single-origin, and the president's on-record denial — "No ... we're way too early to even be thinking about that" — is carried beside it at its scope [C]. The House Judiciary minority's "Pardons, Inc." report is rejected as to its causal narrative; its component facts — the October pardon, \$260,000 in Binance lobbying — are separately sourced and pre-date the window [C]. Fox News's attribution of the \$93.78 Brent settlement to August 21 conflicts with CNBC's August 20 and is rejected as a dated fact until anchored to the exchange [C]. Three year-to-date custody-death tallies of 24, 25, and 26 are kept as labeled tracker counts and not merged; the agency's own notification list is the anchor [C].

Checked for and not found. An Insurrection Act proclamation or Guard federalization in the Federal Register feed for August 14–23 **ABSENT**. A Supreme Court order on 26A124 or 26A139 in five order lists **ABSENT**. A contempt order or order to show cause in *Phang v. Blanche*, on two docket mirrors **ABSENT**. Execution of the Preska-authorized production; any newly named individual **ABSENT**. A Federal Register publication of the Section 2(c)(2) redaction log **ABSENT**. An ICE death notification in the window **ABSENT**. An ICE detention dataset newer than July 20 **ABSENT**. A Treasury or Justice Department response to any of the three Warren letters on WLFI buyers **ABSENT**. An opened DoD Inspector General investigation of the 1789 Capital awards **ABSENT**. A filing linking Stargate capital to family revenue, on EDGAR and the Federal Register **ABSENT**. A subpoena identifying Polymarket wallet holders, WLFI stake buyers, or an envoy's market position — the tenth consecutive report **ABSENT**. A White House physician's memorandum, a 25th Amendment statement by any member or official, a new third-term statement after August 15 **ABSENT**. A Senate or House vote of any kind; Congress is in recess until September 14 **ABSENT**.

Next week's priorities

August 24, the Treasury press conference on the Iran economic operation — the designations themselves, not the adjectives. August 25 through 27 in *Phang v. Blanche*: the department's response to the handwritten-notes notice, due August 27, read for whether it addresses the withholding or the category. *League of Women Voters v. Trump*, D. Mass. ECF 189: any ruling on the emergency motion to enforce, and any Supreme Court order on 26A124 — either is a lead; a twenty-eighth day of silence is also reportable. August 27, the Mega Hub response deadline as SAM records it, against the agency's own August 31, and the New York Times amended complaint in the Florida defamation case. August 28: the deadline on the Warren–Garcia stock-trades letter, and the joint letter due to Judge Preska on the remaining sealed material. September 2, Missouri Supreme Court argument on the referendum; September 3, the Phang reply and the FCC's opposition to Disney's temporary-restraining-order motion in D.D.C. 1:26-cv-02902. Standing: the Duckworth bill's text on congress.gov; the Central Command permalinks; the Camp East Montana modification if it posts; the *Lincoln's* homecoming and any Navy release with the deployment length.

Method: eight parallel research tracks, each a leaf agent with no delegation, spawned in one message; every finding published at tier A was opened by the main thread at its primary record — the Federal Register public-inspection PDF and API, five Supreme Court order lists and two dockets, four RECAP filings read in full, the 10-Q, the OCC decision, the 278e, the SAM notice, USAspending award records, the Senate vote file. Syndications counted as single origins throughout. Number drift anchored where found: the Brent settlement dates; the DCAS increment of fifty, fifty-nine, or sixty; the Missouri hearing date; the Mega Hub deadline. Fetch-restricted origins this week, read via curl with a browser agent or through syndication where noted: justice.gov, supremecourt.gov docket pages, courtlistener.com HTML, centcom.mil, congress.gov, cnn.com, nytimes.com, thehill.com, nbcnews.com, washingtonpost.com, cnbc.com, ice.gov, sec.gov HTML.